

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

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Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

Evaluator: Leomer Bares
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Product: Garbage Truck Tracker
Task:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

No real-time update if the garbage truck is already nearby or delayed.
No loading indicator when fetching schedule data.

Recommendations

Add real-time status like "Truck arriving in 10 minutes."
Display last updated at time

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

The icons are unclear not to be related to garbage collection.

Schedule format is confusing (e.g., 14:00 instead of 2:00 PM)

Recommendations

The use of 12 hour of the time format with AM/PM.

The Use clear icons like truck or trash bin.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is Undo and Redo supported?

Issues

No option to go back easily from schedule screen.

Cannot cancel notifications once enabled.

Recommendations

Add back button and easy navigation

Allow users to toggle notifications on/off

Provide undo option for actions

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Menu layout changes in different sections.

Recommendations

Use consistent button design and colors

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

Users can select wrong schedule without confirmation.

Recommendations

Add confirmation dialogs before saving actions.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Users must remember their selected location.

Important info like next pickup date is not highlighted.

No labels on icons.

Recommendations

Display saved location clearly.

Highlight next schedule prominently.

Add labels or tooltips for icons.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

No shortcuts for frequent locations.

No filtering or sorting of schedules.

Recommendations

Allow users to save favorite locations.

Provide quick access buttons for common actions.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

Too much information on one screen.

Cluttered layout with unnecessary elements.

Recommendations

Simplify layout and show only essential info.

Remove unnecessary elements.

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

No visual indication of what went wrong.

Recommendations

The Use clear messages like “No schedule found for your area

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

No explanation of features like notifications.

First-time users may feel confused.

Recommendations

Provide short instructions or tooltips.

Include onboarding guide for new users